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COVER STORY

Darryl McDaniels of Run-DMC on Sobriety: 'I'm Not Afraid to Face Myself'

Twenty years sober, Run-DMC's Darryl McDaniels opens up about his recovery journey.

Healthline

Courtesy of Stand Together

Rock & Roll Hall of Famer Darryl "DMC" McDaniels, of the legendary hip-hop group Run-DMC, is speaking out about sobriety.

McDaniels shares his journey with addiction, his mental health, and finding sobriety over 20 years ago.

The iconic rapper teamed up with 1 Million Strong to unite the music, sports, and entertainment industry and its fans to foster meaningful connections at cultural events.

At the height of global fame, Darryl "DMC" McDaniels from the legendary hip-hop band Run-DMC quietly battled addiction, depression, and identity loss.

"I never wanted to be in show business... I was just writing rhymes. I was a comic book kid. I had a great imagination. So it was an easy transition from rapping in my basement to rapping onstage in front of a lot of people," he told Healthline.

When Run-DMC's career skyrocketed, and the pressure of churning out hits intensified, McDaniels said the rise to stardom took a toll.

"[People] started saying, 'You gotta have hit records. You gotta tour. You gotta be on the radio. You gotta make money.' And I started worrying about their expectations. I started worrying about letting people down instead of worrying about how I was feeling," he said.

That's when anxiety, nervousness, and confusion set in.

"And I thought, 'Oh, I need something to help me.' Olde English 800. Johnny Walker. Jack Daniel's. Jim Beam. I thought they could be my friends," said McDaniels. "It wasn't Run-DMC itself. It was the expectations. I started reaching for things outside of me to help me navigate what I was feeling."

After battling addiction, anxiety, and depression for decades, he checked himself into rehab in 2004. Since then, McDaniels has lived a life of sobriety and made it his mission to spread awareness around mental health.

His latest endeavor is a partnership with 1 Million Strong, an impact initiative working to transform the way society thinks about mental health, addiction, and recovery by building sober-supportive communities within the music world and beyond.

Substance misuse affects 56% of music industry

Substance misuse is widespread in the United States. In 2023, nearly 50 million Americans ages 12 and older met criteria for a substance use disorder.

In the music industry, more than half of professionals report problematic alcohol or drug use. What's more, around 34% of touring music professionals experience clinical depression.

"A major misunderstanding is the belief that strength, success, or intelligence protects people from mental illness or addiction," J. Craig Allen, MD, Vice President of Addiction Services at Hartford HealthCare, told Healthline. "Mental health problems and addiction are health conditions, not a moral flaw."

While improvements and setbacks with addiction and mental health occur, he added that for mental health and substance use disorder, there is a misperception that when that happens, a treatment has “failed.”

“In reality, recovery is best understood as an active maintenance phase, not a cure. Ongoing vulnerability should be normalized without minimizing consequences, and early warning signs should prompt rapid response, not shame or thoughts of defeat,” said Allen.

Connection is the opposite of addiction

In addition to medications and psychotherapy, sober-supportive communities are important for recovery and reduce multiple risks for return to use by:

reducing isolation

creating early detection systems for increased risk flags

acting as a safety net network by including peers, family, clinicians, and sponsors

“It’s often said that the opposite of addiction is connection. Reliable connection is key,” Allen said.

McDaniels agreed. Providing opportunities for connection is why he teamed up with 1 Million Strong.

“1 Million Strong lets people know you don’t have to go through this alone. You don’t have to hang with Johnnie Walker and Jack Daniel’s,” McDaniels said.

“There’s a whole community that’s always been here, but nobody talked about it. They give me a place to be.”

Darryl McDaniels talks sobriety

Healthline spoke with the Rock & Roll Hall of Famer to learn more about his journey with addiction and mental health, and what he wants others to know about sobriety and his life’s greatest achievement.

This interview has been edited and condensed for clarity and length.

Did you feel pressured to drink and do drugs?

McDaniels : In my community, and especially in the show business community, harmful, destructive behavior is celebrated. If somebody could take 50 shots at the bar, people would say, “Give him more.”

When I was growing up, you were celebrated if you smoked a lot of weed or drank a lot. I was drinking a case of Olde English a day, 40-ounce bottles. Nobody said anything was wrong. They thought it was heroic.

When you get into show business, you can get all the weed, alcohol, and drugs you want, and nobody notices it’s a problem until it’s too late. There was a community that didn’t do

all that stuff, but it wasn’t talked about. It was considered uncool.

Have you always lived with anxiety and depression?

McDaniels: Yeah. It was always there. But when you’re a kid, you have outlets. For me it was comic books, drawing, imagination. When you get into show business, it’s always one, two, three, this is what you need to do.

The relief that’s readily available is drugs. You don’t notice all the other things that are there for you, so you don’t have to do that. I’ve always had anxiety. Even today, I still get scared before I go onstage.

How did therapy and rehab enter your life?

McDaniels: When I was 35, during my alcoholic, suicidal depression, I found out I was adopted. Everybody knew except me — my mother, my parents, my whole family, my teachers, even the nuns at my Catholic school. That made me drink more because I couldn’t deal with those emotions.

I felt betrayed and confused. I also had pancreatitis. I was depressed, suicidal, and drinking. What gave me the confidence to go get sober was meeting another adopted person. It made me realize I wasn’t alone.

I knew if I was going to search for my birth mother, I had to be sober. That pushed me to rehab. Once I got there, I discovered therapy, which is the most powerful thing a person can do. I was diagnosed with suppressed emotions in rehab. Therapy did what Jack Daniel’s and Johnnie Walker couldn’t do for me.

Did you have any positive influences in the music industry?

McDaniels: Yeah. The story I always tell is from 1988. We were on tour — Run-DMC, EPMD, Public Enemy — and we were standing on the side of the stage watching Eric B. & Rakim. The conversation came up: what is making hip hop so cool right now and good for us?

We talked about the money, playing arenas, sneaker deals, making movies. Then it went to, man, we could get all the weed we want, all the beer and liquor and cigarettes and cocaine that we want. We were touring, living a drugs-and-rock-and-roll lifestyle. Everybody’s hotel bathtub was filled with ice and beer. We were all happy.

Then it was Chuck D’s turn to speak. Chuck was probably like 24 years old. And with that Godly voice, he said, “I never got high a day in my life.” That hit me because he’s my favorite rapper of all time. I went back to my dressing room and sat down thinking, if he never got high a goddamn day in his life, why does he rap so good? That totally blew my mind.

Fast forward 30 years, and we’re on a panel in New York City talking about sobriety and recovery. The moderator is Henry Rollins. After the panel, I asked Henry how long he’d

been sober, and he said, “Oh, DMC, I’ve never gotten high a damn day in my life.”

That took me right back to Chuck. It made me realize there is a community of people who are powerful, aggressive, creative, and successful, who go through all the ups and downs and never had to get high a damn day in their lives. That community does exist. I needed to know that then. And the funny thing is, Henry said Chuck’s a very good friend of his.

What do you hope others learn from your experience?

McDaniels: When you’re going through something, you feel like you’re the only one in the world going through it.

Once I realized there were other people struggling like me, and doing something about it, I could do something about it too. It took me 30 years to find healing and recovery. I want people to know they don’t have to wait that long.

Do you hope to address stigma around mental health?

McDaniels: Yes. Stigma exists because people talk about problems but don’t give solutions. 1 Million Strong says you can still go to concerts, still live your life, and still have support.

If you remove guilt and shame , you remove stigma.

Is it rewarding to perform sober?

McDaniels: Yes. I wasn’t always high when I performed. I was using substances to alter my feelings.

Now I see things I was too drunk to see before. I’m still scared to go onstage. I’d rather be in my basement rhyming in a mirror, but now I face it instead of numbing it.

What strategies or self-care techniques do you use now?

McDaniels: I go to the gym. I exercise . I got back into comic books. All the stuff people thought wasn’t cool when I was young is actually the strongest stuff you can do.

When I went to rehab, I was diagnosed with suppressed emotions. Now I’m not afraid to face myself.

Looking back, what’s the biggest lesson you’ve learned?

McDaniels: There’s something powerful about admitting you’re scared, afraid, or confused. When you admit you need help, everything that exists to help you will come to you.

My greatest achievement isn’t records or awards; it’s that I’m living proof you can beat whatever you’re struggling against.

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FRONT PAGE

Report from Jerusalem: As Israel Keeps Bombing Iran, Palestinians Face Growing Violence in West Bank

Democracy Now!

Democracy Now! speaks with Iranian Israeli political activist Orly Noy about her recent piece, “Longing for My Tehran.” “It’s been a very emotional time since the beginning of the war, not just because we are constantly running in and out of shelters,” says Noy, “but because this time, the footage of the bombing that I grew accustomed to seeing for over two years from the genocide in Gaza was now coming from my homeland.”

Noy also comments on Israeli political support for the war on Iran, saying “the very few attempts to protest against the war were brutally crushed by the Israeli police.” Israeli violence against Palestinians in the West Bank is also increasing. “Up until now, our worry was about the ethnic cleansing of the West Bank. Now it is just about executing Palestinians, both by the army and by the settlers,” says Noy.

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FEATURES

This Sunshine Week, Florida reflects an alarming national trend of blocking the public's access to information

David Cuillier, Director of the Brechner Freedom of Information Project, College of Journalism and Communications, University of Florida · The Conversation (Politics)

By all measures, the ability to see what the government is up to in the United States has plummeted to new depths since the beginning of the second Trump administration.

For National Sunshine Week in 2025, I wrote about secrecy creep , the adoption of federal secrecy protections implemented by state and local authorities. In Florida and throughout the United States, this threatens the public's right to be informed about its government.

A year later, this creep toward secrecy has become an all-out slide.

As director of the Joseph L. Brechner Freedom of Information Project at the University of Florida, I track the state of government transparency in the U. S. What has changed since January 2025 is unprecedented.

Clouds in the Sunshine State

Florida is a good example of this slide. Once viewed as a leader in transparency , the Sunshine State now charges exorbitant copy fees that discourage average people from requesting public records .

According to the nonprofit MuckRock, 24% of public records requests in Florida come with a copy fee , averaging US\$1,623. Only Oregon charges fees more often, at 28% of the time. Fees are intended to help agencies cover the cost of large requests, but they tend to be arbitrary and are often used as a way to get pesky people to go away.

And that's assuming you even get the information you want. One of my own studies from 2019 indicated that, on average, if you requested a public record in Florida, you would receive it about 39% of the time , placing the state 31st in the nation.

In 2025, MuckRock put the percentage dipping lower, at 35% . In March 2026, it was at 34% .

In Florida, more and more government agencies are thwarting the public's right to know, including attempts to hide the details behind Alligator Alcatraz , the temporary immigrant detention center built in the Florida Everglades in June 2025. The state's Department of Government Efficiency, or DOGE, office has pushed cities to be more transparent while withholding its own records .

Members of the state Legislature are attempting to strengthen the public records law . This would improve transparency in Florida's state government, but I'd argue it doesn't go far enough. Other states, such as Ohio, Pennsylvania and Connecticut, have implemented stronger laws, including independent enforcement of their sunshine laws , to ensure their governments comply.

It starts at the top

State and local governments appear to be taking their cues from the federal government.

President Donald Trump's administration heralds itself as the most transparent in history , pointing to the president's willingness to talk informally to the press or directly to the public through social media.

While that may be one definition of transparency, the federal government's willingness to provide documents that show what the government is doing – not just what it says it is doing – has been eviscerated under the second Trump administration. Examples include:

This led some agencies, such as the Department of Energy, to apply unorthodox practices, including closing out pending requests.

David Cuillier, Director of the Brechner Freedom of Information Project, College of Journalism and Communications, University of Florida

Refusing to provide tax returns , again, unlike every other president in modern history, and then suing the IRS for \$10 billion when some returns were leaked.

Removing government websites and databases .

Firing the national archivist and the director of the Office of Information Policy , the agency within the U. S. Department of Justice that oversees government agencies' compliance with requests under the Freedom of Information Act , or FOIA.

Firing and pushing out experienced staffers assigned to handle FOIA requests as part of the 2025 U. S. DOGE purges . This led some agencies, such as the Department of Energy, to apply unorthodox practices, including closing out pending requests .

Axing the new Open Government Federal Advisory Committee , which was launched to find ways of improving FOIA.

Pulling out of the Open Government Partnership , which the U. S. helped found in 2011 to foster transparency around the globe.

As the federal government has taken steps to become less transparent, many state and local governments have followed. Anadolu/Anadolu via Getty Images

Typically, the Department of Justice releases annual statistics on FOIA requests every March. When I examined initial reports posted in January, when just 11 agencies had provided their reports, backlogs – that is, requests that remain

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Pete Hegseth is working hard to make sure the public hears only good news about Iran war

Kathy Kiely, Professor and Lee Hills Chair of Free Press Studies, University of Missouri-Columbia · The Conversation (Politics)

The Trump administration doesn't like the free press's coverage of the Iran war. MirageC/Getty

Martha Gellhorn stowed away on a hospital ship to become the only woman journalist to land on Normandy Beach on D-Day. She carried stretchers before writing her harrowing account of the invasion.

The New Yorker's famously epicurean writer A. J. Liebling subsisted on military rations and came under fire during World War II to describe what it was like for the soldiers and sailors at war.

Syndicated columnist Ernie Pyle died, in a helmet and Army fatigues, among some of the troops whose names and hometowns he carefully included in his dispatches. "At this spot, the 77th Infantry lost a buddy," read the makeshift sign posted at the place where a Japanese machine gun bullet felled him.

Those reporters told stories of war in all its gore and its glory, its exhilaration and its ennui. Others have laid bare the anxiety and doubts.

Veteran Vietnam correspondent Neil Sheehan broke the story of the Pentagon Papers, which showed how government officials deceived the public about the Vietnam war. Sheehan won a Pulitzer Prize for his book, "A Bright Shining Lie," which chronicled the war's impact on idealists who once believed in it, through the story of his relationship with an inside source.

Well before bombs started dropping on Iran and President Donald Trump began to tease the notion of a ground invasion, his defense secretary, Pete Hegseth, began putting obstacles in the way of the reporters with the most experience covering the nation's military. While Hegseth's moves haven't stopped the reporters from doing their jobs, it has made it harder for them to keep the public informed.

As someone who worked as a Washington correspondent for decades, I worry that these obstacles could limit the number of reporters who have the experience with – and trust of – key sources to do the kind of in-depth, nuanced journalism that a war, with its price in lives and resources, deserves.

A group of press correspondents on board a U. S. landing craft en route to amphibious maneuvers off the coast of England on May 8, 1944, including, with his back to the camera on right, A. J. Liebling of The New Yorker magazine. AP photo

Corralling the watchdogs

Generally, war correspondents need the cooperation of the military they are covering to get to the front. For the U.

S. press, that requires relationships and credibility at the Pentagon.

Early in 2025, Hegseth ordered major news organizations to give up their desks in the Pentagon press room to MAGA favorites. NPR's desk went to Breitbart News. Roaming the hallways, where reporters sometimes found sources who would deviate from the company line, became verboten.

Eventually, the area in the Pentagon where reporters were allowed was circumscribed to a single corridor outside the press room – even though the public affairs officers who worked most closely with reporters were in an office on the other side of the 6½-million-square-foot building.

Then Hegseth conditioned the issuance of press credentials on reporters, effectively giving military brass the right to censor or sanitize their reports.

As a result, almost the entire Pentagon press corps, which included outlets ranging from The Associated Press to The New York Times to Fox News and USNI News, which covers the Navy, moved out of the building in October 2025. Some have been invited back for the press briefings Hegseth and Gen. Dan Caine, chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff, have begun to give on progress of the battle in Iran.

But after the first of these briefings, the Pentagon abruptly banned photographers from attending, reportedly because Hegseth's staff found some of their images of him to be unflattering.

Secretary on defense

Gone are the off-camera "background" briefings where Department of Defense brass could give trusted reporters greater context and nuance for battlefield decisions. Gone are the impromptu hallway meetings where reporters have, with luck or persistence, picked up information that deviates from an administration's agreed-upon script.

Also not in evidence, at least not so far: the deployment of the kind of journalistic embed program that the Pentagon used during the Iraq war to give the American people an up-close look at troops in the conflict zone.

How might that affect what you, the public, gets to know? It was a combination of an anonymous tip and insider access that led the legendary investigative reporter Seymour Hersh to break the devastating story of My Lai, the American soldiers' massacre of civilians during the Vietnam War.

At the made-for-TV briefings he does hold, Hegseth devotes most of the session to questions from outlets such as the Epoch Times, The Daily Caller and LindellTV – owned by Mike Lindell, the head of the well-known pillow company.

At one recent briefing, one of the favored new cadre tossed Hegseth a shameless softball. Referring to American troops in the Middle East, the questioner asked: "What is your prayer for them?"

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People Who Eat More Red Meat May Have Higher Risk of Type 2 Diabetes

Healthline

A recent study suggests that a higher intake of red meat may be associated with an increased risk of diabetes. Image Credit: VICUSCHKA/Getty Images

A recent study found that a person's red meat consumption may increase their risk of type 2 diabetes.

The findings also suggest that consuming alternative proteins may help reduce the risk of diabetes.

Nutrition experts offer alternative protein options to red meat to help maintain overall health.

Diabetes is a growing health concern in the United States. According to the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC), 40.1 million people had diabetes in 2023, and 115.2 million had prediabetes.

The CDC also notes that among those with diabetes, 90% to 95% have type 2 diabetes.

Type 2 diabetes can generally be prevented or delayed with lifestyle changes, such as diet, exercise, and weight management.

A recent study published in the British Journal of Nutrition found that higher red meat intake was associated with a higher risk of diabetes.

It also found that substituting red meat for other protein sources may help lower a person's risk of developing diabetes.

"This study adds to a consistent body of research showing that higher red meat intake is linked with higher rates of type 2 diabetes," said Michelle Routhenstein, a preventive cardiology dietitian at Entirely Nourished, who was not involved in the study.

"In this large NHANES analysis, those eating the most red meat had about 49% higher odds of having diabetes compared to those eating the least. When we see similar findings across different types of research, it strengthens the overall message," Routhenstein told Healthline.

Higher red meat intake and diabetes risk

In this population-based cross-sectional study, the researchers analyzed data from the National Health and Nutrition Examination Survey (NHANES) from 2003 to 2016.

They defined having diabetes as "being diagnosed by a physician or other health professional, having a fasting plasma glucose of 126 mg/dL or higher, an HbA1c level of 6.5% or higher, or the use of antidiabetic drugs."

The study included 34,737 participants with an average age of 45.8. Among these, 10.5% had diabetes. Those who had

the highest intake of total red meat consumed an average of 5.72 ounces per day.

After the researchers adjusted for demographics, lifestyle, socioeconomic status, and other dietary habits, they found that higher red meat consumption was associated with increased diabetes risk.

However, it is important to note that association does not establish a causal relationship. "While this type of study cannot prove cause and effect, the results closely align with long-term prospective studies that show a clear dose-response relationship, especially for processed red meat," Routhenstein said.

After repeated analyses, the researchers found that each additional serving of total red meat per day was associated with a 16% increased risk of diabetes. They also found that each serving of processed or unprocessed red meat gave a 10% higher risk of diabetes.

"Red meat is generally defined to include beef, veal, pork, lamb, and game meat," said David Cutler, MD, board certified family medicine physician at Providence Saint John's Health Center in Santa Monica, CA, who was not involved in the study.

"There are longstanding recommendations from nutrition and diabetes experts to limit red meat by consuming it only in low frequency and small amounts, choosing leaner cuts and avoiding processed meats, like bacon, ham, and sausages, altogether. I suggest no more than two servings of red meat per week, with a serving [being] about the size of your fist, 4 to 6 ounces," Cutler told Healthline.

Routhenstein elaborated by recommending no more than 1 serving per week of red meat.

"If eliminating it right away feels overwhelming, a helpful first step is transitioning to leaner cuts such as sirloin, tenderloin, or 90–95% lean ground beef," she said. "The goal is not total avoidance, but shifting red meat from a daily habit to an occasional choice."

Red meat substitutions may lower diabetes risk by up to 14%

The study analyzed how substituting red meat for other proteins may affect a person's risk of diabetes.

They found that participants who replaced one serving of red meat per day with plant-based protein sources, such as legumes, nuts or seeds, or soy products, showed a 14% reduced risk of diabetes.

Participants who substituted dairy, poultry, or whole grains for red meat saw an 11% to 12% reduction in diabetes risk.

This suggests that replacing red meat with plant-based proteins may be associated with a lower risk of diabetes.

However, causality has yet to be established.

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standard-article(title: [Meta & Google Found Liable in Landmark Cases for Knowingly Causing Harm to Young People], author: [Democracy Now!], images: (), paragraphs: ([Juries in California and New Mexico have found the tech giants Alphabet and Meta liable for knowingly causing harm to children and teens who used their social media platforms. Over the course of the trials, documents revealed that tech companies were well aware of the addictive properties of their social media products and exploited these properties to increase their profits. “They take advantage of the undeveloped frontal cortex of young people and their emotional need for validation by showing them things, not that they want to see, but what they can’t look away from,” says attorney Matthew P. Bergman, who represented the plaintiffs in the California case.], [Youth advocate Zamaan Qureshi, who testified in the New Mexico case against Meta, says the verdicts indicate that “Meta’s house of cards is falling, and it is absolutely clear that they will be held accountable.”],), insert-map: (:), word-count: 142, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false,)

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brief-group(([

Mirit Eyal-Cohen and Jay A. Soled, opinion contributor, The Hill (general): The tax code should make clear that activities fused with fun, excitement and personal enjoyment are never an occasion for a tax deduction.

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Sarah Davis, The Hill (general): Reza Pahlavi, the exiled crown prince of Iran, said freedom in Iran is “within reach” in a speech at the Conservative Political Action Conference (CPAC) on Saturday. “A free Iran is not a fantasy,” Pahlavi said. “A free Iran is within reach right now, but as we all know, freedom never comes free.” The son...

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Jules Yap, IKEA Hackers: A new IKEA study has confirmed what many of us have suspected while staring into cluttered cabinets: our kitchens just aren’t working for us. The good news? You don’t need a full renovation to turn things around. According to the IKEA Cooking & Eating Report 2026, one of the largest studies of its kind, surveying over 31,000 people across 31 countries, fewer than one in three of us are actually happy with our kitchens. And the number one culprit? Space. [...]

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Douglas MacKinnon, opinion contributor, The Hill (general): President Trump’s instinct now is to fight for his country. But to do so, he needs to hear the good, the bad, and the ugly surrounding every policy or potential military operation.

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Sarah Davis, The Hill (general): Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi pledged his country will “exact HEAVY price” after he said the Israeli military violated the Trump administration’s pause on strikes against Iranian energy infrastructure. “Israel has hit 2 of Iran’s largest steel factories, a power plant and civilian nuclear sites among other infrastructure. Israel claims it acted in coordination with...

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Jeffrey Blehar, National Review: Demonstrators gather in front of law enforcement officers during a protest at Immigration and Customs Enforcement headquarters in Portland, Ore., October 4, 2025.

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Angela Giuffrida in Rome, The Guardian: Prime minister is scrambling to clean up

her government after youth vote powered a damaging referendum defeat

Filippo Micheleni was having a drink at San Calisto, a popular bar in Rome's Trastevere neighbourhood on Wednesday night. As he chatted to his friends, Giorgia Meloni's far-right government was reeling from a failed referendum , and her beleaguered tourism minister, Daniela Santanchè, had just resigned .

Micheleni, a 29-year-old computer scientist who lives in Brussels, was spending a few days in the Italian capital after returning home last weekend to cast his ballot in the plebiscite on judicial changes.

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Reuters, The Guardian: US president says he will host Chinese leader in a reciprocal visit later this year

Middle East crisis – live updates

Donald Trump will meet Xi Jinping in May during the US president's first visit to China in eight years, a closely watched trip that had been postponed due to the Iran war.

Trump was initially slated to travel next week, but will now visit Beijing on 14 and 15 May, he wrote in a post on Truth Social on Wednesday. Trump said he would host the Chinese leader in a reciprocal visit in Washington later this year.

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Mike Lillis, The Hill (general): House lawmakers on Friday passed a Republican bill to fund the Department of Homeland Security (DHS) in its entirety for eight weeks, after GOP leaders rejected a Senate-passed bill that would exclude money for immigration enforcement. The partisan package was a nod to conservative immigration hawks, who hailed Speaker Mike Johnson (R-La.) for pushing it...

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Australian Associated Press, The Guardian: Critical Western Australia agriculture region counting cost of brutal cyclone as flooding risk persists for low-lying communities

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An agricultural region that supplies about 60% of Western Australia's fresh winter produce is assessing damage as authorities continue work on Sunday to restore power to a popular tourist town hit hard by Cyclone Narelle.

The food-bowl region near Carnarvon, about 900km north of Perth, provides 80% of the state's bananas. Meanwhile, flooding risk remains in the state's low-lying communities.

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Tolu Talabi, The Hill (general): Idaho lawmakers approved legislation Friday that would criminalize transgender people for using bathrooms and changing rooms associated with the gender they identify with, whether inside a government or privately owned building. The bill, which senators approved in a 28-7 vote, states that any person who knowingly and willfully uses the space designated for use by...

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Donna Ferguson, The Guardian: Model posted pictures of herself naked and 'in her full power' to celebrate Mother's Day, before Meta took them down for breaching nudity guidelines

The model Erin O'Connor has spoken out about the need for social media platforms to apply "clearer, more context-sensitive guidelines" after Instagram repeatedly removed two nude photographs she had posted on Mother's Day, celebrating her heavily pregnant body.

The photos – which were removed, reinstated and then removed again by the platform – were taken in 2014 when O'Connor, who is 48, was eight and half months' pregnant with her son Albert.

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Carolehorst, Variety: The 29th Sonoma Intl. Film Festival wrapped March 29 with Spanish film "Maspalomas" winning the Grand Jury Award for best narrative feature. In a statement, the jury noted that directors Aitor Arregi and Jose Mari Goenaga's film was "an authentic and rare depiction of an elder man confronting personal and physical crisis at the onset [...]"

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Democracy Now!, Democracy Now!: Democracy Now! celebrated its 30th anniversary at the historic Riverside Church in New York City with live performances by guests including the Pulitzer Prize-winning Palestinian poet Mosab Abu Toha. Mosab Abu Toha read his poem "Under the Rubble" and spoke about his experience surviving Israel's genocide of Gaza, which killed 30 members of his extended family. Watch the full event here .

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Stacy Randall, IKEA Hackers: Most people flinch when they see a praying mantis. But what if you gave one a home so stunning, it stopped you in your tracks instead? I admit, a mantis terrarium isn't something I've ever thought about making. I mean, it is pretty specific, but it's also really cool, especially if you're into insects. The more I looked at this hack, the more I thought about just how special it is. My son loves bugs, and the ones that pop [...]

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Ryan Mancini, The Hill (general): The Houthis on Friday warned that if three lines are crossed by the U. S., Israel or other Middle East countries, they will join the Iran war and fight back. The Yemen-based group backed by Iran's Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps released five points, issued by the Yemeni Armed Forces, regarding the conflict. They include demands for...

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Ground Invasion of Iran Could Be “Suicide Mission” for U.S.: Ex-Army Intelligence Analyst

Democracy Now!

We get an analysis of the Trump administration’s Iran war strategy from former U. S. Army intelligence analyst Harrison Mann. “From day two of this war, the Trump administration has not known what to do and how to get out of this,” says Mann, who resigned from the U. S. Army’s Defense Intelligence Agency in 2024 over the Biden administration’s policy in Gaza. As Trump is rumored to be eyeing the oil export hub of Kharg Island for seizure, Mann gives his assessment of a potential ground invasion of Iran. “Any attempt to seize this island would be close to a suicide mission,” he says. While U. S. leaders struggle to respond to Iran’s blockade of the Strait of Hormuz and attacks on military bases in U. S.-allied Gulf states, Mann notes that “the people who drove [Trump] into this war pretty much expected this.

I don’t think this is a surprise to Lindsey Graham and Marco Rubio or Benjamin Netanyahu — who is very much getting what he wanted, which is dragging the U. S. into what he hopes will be a decisive war of annihilation against Iran.”

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